

2.1 Skill Acquisition

This topic will develop learners' knowledge and understanding of the role of skill acquisition in performance of physical activities and sports. It aims to develop knowledge and understanding of the principles required in order to optimise the learning of new, and the development of existing, skills.

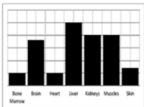
Learners will develop an understanding of the importance of being able to classify skills in order to select the most suitable approach to the learning of motor skills.

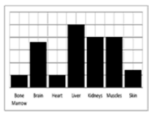
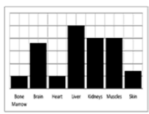
This topic looks at the underlying factors required for effective and efficient performance. Learners will also gain a detailed understanding of the impact of

the environment and conditions in which new skills are learned on the success of acquiring these motor skills.

Knowledge and understanding will also be developed in the different approaches and theories to teaching new skills as well as the guidance and feedback used to support this. Focus will also be placed on enhancing existing skills and the opportunities to transfer between the two.

Through application of knowledge gained from this topic, learners will be able to develop their skills in other sporting roles such as coach or leader, as well as directly relating it to their own performance.

Topic Area	Content
Classification of skills 	- justification of placement of skills on continua: - difficulty (simple/complex) - environmental influence (open/closed) - pacing (self-paced/externally paced) - muscular involvement (gross/fine) - continuity (discrete/serial/continuous) - organisation (low/high).
Types and methods of practice 	- characteristics and uses of each: - part practice - whole practice - whole/part-whole practice - progressive/part practice - massed practice - distributed practice - fixed practice - varied practice.
Transfer of skills 	- types of transfer: - positive - negative - proactive - retroactive - bilateral - know and understand the ways of optimising the effect of positive transfer - know and understand the ways of limiting the effect of negative transfer.
Principles and theories of learning movement skills 	- theories of learning: - operant conditioning - cognitive theory of learning - Bandura's theory of social/observational learning.
Stages of learning 	- characteristics of the stages of learning: - cognitive - associative - autonomous.
Guidance  	- types and uses of guidance: - verbal guidance - visual guidance - manual guidance - mechanical guidance - advantages and disadvantages of using each type of guidance.

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Feedback  	- types and uses of feedback: - intrinsic - extrinsic - positive - negative - knowledge of performance - knowledge of results - advantages and disadvantages of using each type of feedback.
*Memory models  	- Atkinson and Shiffren's multi-store memory model - use of selective attention - Craik and Lockhart's levels of processing model - relate both models to learning and performing physical activity skills.